

The Use Case: Doaa's College Decision

Step 1: Present

Doaa opens the Decision Mirror and writes in the context tab:

"I need to choose a college major and I'm so confused. I keep going back and forth. Computer Science feels safe and practical but sometimes I wonder if I'm just doing what makes sense on paper. Design and Arts feels exciting but also scary — like I'd be choosing passion over stability."

She adds her options:

1. Computer Science
 2. Design and Arts
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Step 2: Retrieve

The system pulls Doaa's profile:

Trait profile:

- Problem-solving orientation: High
- Practical/stability-focused: High
- Risk tolerance: Moderate-to-low
- Time horizon: Long-term security weighted heavily
- Locus of priority: Self-interest (career viability)

Relevant past logged decisions:

- *6 months ago*: Chose a paid internship over an unpaid research opportunity (chose stability + income over pure intellectual curiosity)
 - *4 months ago*: Decided to stay in a group project with struggling teammates rather than switch groups (chose social stability + loyalty over optimal outcome)
 - *2 months ago*: Picked a high-paying summer job over traveling (chose security over experience)
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Step 3: Converse

The LLM recognizes that Doaa's profile leans heavily practical, but her opening statement signals *tension* — she explicitly mentions "passion" as a pull. This gap requires more context. The system asks:

Question 1:

"You mentioned Design and Arts feels exciting but scary. Can you describe a moment — maybe in school or a project — when you did something creative just because it genuinely excited you? What happened?"

Question 2:

"Looking back at the choices in your profile — like choosing the paid internship or the summer job — how did you feel afterward? Satisfied you made the smart choice, or did you ever regret missing out on something?"

Question 3:

"If you chose Computer Science and it turned out to be the 'right' career move — good salary, job security — but you spent your whole degree wishing you'd picked Design, would that feel like a win or a loss to you?"

Question 4:

"Design and Arts — is the appeal coming from wanting to do something creative day-to-day, or is it more about the identity of being a 'creative person'? Or both?"

Question 5:

"When you say CS feels 'safe and practical,' does that feel like a genuine preference, or does it feel like something you think you should choose?"

Step 4: Advise (after Doaa answers)

Suppose Doaa answers that:

- She does regret some past "practical" choices
- She'd feel unfulfilled in CS even with security
- The appeal of Design is actually about doing creative work day-to-day, not just identity
- CS feels like "what I should choose," not what she wants

The system then responds (descriptively, not prescriptively):

"Here's what I'm noticing: Your pattern shows you lean practical and stability-focused — that's real, and it's shown up consistently in your past choices. But there's something else in your history too: when you chose pure security, you felt regret. That matters.

And here's the tension: you're describing Design as exciting but scary, while CS feels like the 'should.' In your past, when you've chosen 'should' over genuine interest, your profile updated to show lower satisfaction.

Your actual pattern isn't 'always pick the safe thing' — it's 'pick the safe thing, then feel conflicted.' The data suggests the real choice here isn't CS vs. Design. It's whether you're willing to pursue something that excites you while building the practical skills to make it sustainable.

That's different from what your caution is telling you right now. Your pattern actually leans toward you choosing Design — not despite your practicality, but because your history shows that's when you're most honest with yourself."